Time Audit User Guide (V1.25.1)

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Interactive version: Time Audit User Guide

1. Get started

Sign in with Google, then use Authorize sync at the top to grant Google Drive access. Sign-in and Drive authorization are separate. If Drive is disconnected in a later session, authorize it again. Preview mode stores data only in the current browser; clearing browser storage may remove it. On iPhone, open the site in Safari and choose Share → Add to Home Screen. In Chrome or Edge, use the browser's Install action. Sync still needs internet and authorization.

2. Record your day

On Today, add an entry and adjust the start and end times. The default interval is only a starting point; sleep can be one long block. Pick a frequent activity or search. Categories help you browse, while each saved activity has its own ID. Work meeting and Research meeting are separate activities; Research remains available for focused research. Learning / research and Family are category names, and renaming them does not change existing activity IDs. Family includes chores, family time, family trips, parent-child time, time with a partner, and visiting family; caregiving remains under Care. Existing Meeting entries keep their Work activity ID; edit any that were research meetings to select Research meeting. Choose Other to add a reusable activity and adjust its category later in Settings. Feeling, importance, urgency, and value alignment are optional 1–7 ratings; higher means more. You may also add a description and link values or goals. Use Calendar to find and backfill gaps. Swipe left on Today to move forward one day and right to move back; desktop users can use the date arrows.

When you select an unrecorded gap on an earlier date, the form starts at that gap and suggests an end one reminder interval later, without passing the gap's end. You can still choose any valid duration. If you change the start of a new entry before manually editing its end, the end moves with it and preserves the duration.

Personal finance includes budgeting / bookkeeping, banking / post office, investing / market review, currency exchange / foreign funds, and insurance / taxes. Use General finances when a task does not fit one group. Existing custom “理财” entries move into this category while retaining their activity IDs and records.

3. Keep a daily journal

The journal includes an activity summary that updates when more entries are added. Write a personal note and optionally rate daily mood from 1 to 7. Notes autosave. Try the microphone for dictation; if browser speech recognition is unavailable, use your phone keyboard microphone and review the resulting text.

4. Read insights

Choose today, the last 3, 7, or 30 days, six months, or one year. Reflection also has adjustable ranges. Check data quality and unrecorded hours before interpreting allocation, ratings, and goal time. Charts use actual duration, not entry count. Weekly rhythm displays seven days and 24 hours; the boundary view checks work against the hours you set. Mood comparisons are exploratory prompts, not diagnoses. Consider unrated and unrecorded time too.

5. Turn reflection into action

Read the review cards, open source entries, and decide whether a pattern fits your experience. Try one small if–then experiment per week, such as “If I start watching a show after dinner, then I will read for ten minutes first.” Compare before and after. Values and goals can be created in Settings and linked to entries. Zero goal minutes can simply mean that data has not been linked.

6. Sync, backup, and privacy

After Drive authorization, use the top-bar sync button and watch its progress. Make sure both devices sync before switching. In Settings → Backup & restore, sync first and create an independent JSON copy in your Google Drive. You can inspect a copy before restoring it; the current Drive files are archived first. Update other devices to V1.25.1 before syncing after a restore. You can also download JSON or CSV locally and import JSON. Settings also includes language, font/sidebar size, reminders while the browser is open, activity category management, optional IPIP-50, and update checks.

To introduce Time Audit to someone, open Settings → Share Time Audit and show the QR code. Tap it to enlarge, copy the site link, or download the image. The shared link contains none of your personal entries.

A good start: Record for 3–7 days, including sleep and rest, before interpreting charts. Then choose one small experiment.